

Commenting on Visuals

Visuals help you to give a lot of information in a short space of time. They are really 'quick snapshots' of situations, developments, events and processes which would take a long time to explain fully in words.

Good visuals speak for themselves and require little or no description, but you often need to draw your audience's attention to one or more key points before you discuss them in more detail:

- | | |
|---------------------------|---|
| 1. Highlights | Which parts of the visual are most significant? |
| 2. Comments | Why? |
| 3. Interpretations | What conclusions can you draw? |

TASK 1

These expressions highlight important information in a visual. Complete them using the following words:

on to at out about

- | | |
|------------------------------|--|
| us to look | 1. this part of the graph in more detail. |
| us to focus our attention | 2. one particularly important feature. |
| I'd like you to think | 3. the significance of this figure here. |
| to point | 4. one or two interesting details. |
| to draw your attention | 5. the upper half of the chart. |

TASK 2

These expressions comment on important information in a visual. Complete them using the following words:

If As Whatever Whichever However

- you can see, there are several surprising developments.
- you look at it more closely, you'll notice a couple of apparent anomalies.
- you try to explain it, this is very bad news.
- the reasons for this, the underlying trend is obvious.
- way you look at it, these are some of our best results ever.

TASK 3

These expressions interpret important information in a visual. Complete them using the following words:

lesson message significance conclusions implications

- | | | |
|---------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| | 1. to be drawn from this are | |
| | 2. to be learned from this is | |
| I'm sure the | 3. of this are | clear to all of us. |
| | 4. of this is | |
| | 5. here is | |

Now highlight all the useful expressions, eg. *I'd like us to look at*, *I'd like us to focus our attention on* etc.

TASK 4

In the box below prepare a visual which is relevant to your work, company or interests. Present it several times, using the suggested expressions to help you.

Introduction and Explanation

Take a look at this / Let's have a look at this / I'd like you to look at this.

Here we can see

The represents And the represents

Highlights and Comments

I'd like us to look at in more detail. As you can see,

I'd also like to draw your attention to

If you look at it more closely, you'll notice

Interpretations

I'm sure the implications of this / the conclusions to be drawn from this are clear to all of us.